

FIVEMILE

GRAYSVILLE · CARDIFF · BROOKSIDE

THE SEPTEMBER 2026 EDITION

MONTHLY

September ran well warmer than usual and came in dry, and Five Mile Creek never reached the high water line.

This edition was put together on October 2, 2026 from our station, the creek gauge at Republic, the Birmingham airport record, and the stories that ran.

SEPTEMBER ALONG THE CREEK

WEATHER

Our station

HOTTEST **101° on Sep 5**

COLDEST **46° on Sep 29**

RAIN **0.85 in**

DAYS OF 90° OR MORE **24**

The average of the highs and lows came to 79.9 degrees, 4.3 degrees warmer than normal for September.

Our station measured 0.85 inches of rain, against a normal of 4.00 at the Birmingham airport. The wettest day was September 11, with 0.53 inches.

At the Birmingham airport, whose record goes back to 1930, it was the second warmest September on the books.

THE CREEK

Five Mile Creek at Republic

HIGHEST **2.27 ft on Sep 21**

LOWEST **1.03 ft on Sep 18**

DAYS AT HIGH WATER **0**

It never reached the high water line, 3.5 feet at Republic.

Its highest reading, 2.27 feet on September 21, was lower than the 3.58 feet the creek reaches in a typical September since 2008.

The high water line is the one the masthead uses. It is not a flood stage, because this gauge does not have one.

STORIES

News page

GRAYSVILLE

4

CARDIFF

1

BROOKSIDE

1

130 stories ran in September, not counting obituaries.

Four were about Graysville, one about Cardiff, and one about Brookside. The rest were about the county and the places around the three towns.

SIGHTINGS

Three towns

NEW TO THE ROLL

4

Four species were recorded in Graysville, Cardiff, and Brookside for the first time on file, among them Plicate Rocksnail, North American Wheel Bug, and Orangenacre Mucket.

HOW THE CALLS DID

THE CALLS FOR SEPTEMBER

Temperature

NOAA

RIGHT

FIVEMILE

RIGHT

Set against the same month in 1991 to 2020 at the Birmingham airport, September finished in the warm third for temperature and the middle third for rain.

NOAA's outlook, issued August 31, gave a 50 percent chance of a warmer than normal month. That was right.

FIVEMILE called it warm, because after a warm August, September had come in warm in 12 of 25 years. That was right.

Since August 2014, NOAA's temperature outlook for these three towns has been right 65 times and missed 33 times, with no lean 46 times. FIVEMILE has been right all three times it has made a call since January 2026. A call made by guessing would be right about one time in three.

THE DOG DAYS

The old belief

THIS YEAR

DID NOT HOLD

The dog days run from July 3 to August 11, named for Sirius, the Dog Star, which lines up with the sun in the middle of them.

The hottest day of the summer at the airport, 102 degrees, came on September 4, outside the dog days.

OCTOBER AHEAD

THE OUTLOOK

October

NOAA

No lean

FIVEMILE

Warmer

NOAA's Climate Prediction Center gives these three towns no lean either way on temperature, and a 40 percent chance of a wetter than normal October.

FIVEMILE's call is a warmer than normal October. After a warm September, October has come in warm in 18 of 33 years at the airport.

FIVEMILE does not call rain. In the airport record a wet month is followed by a wet one no more often than chance would have it.

NORMAL OCTOBER

Birmingham airport

NORMAL HIGH

82° to 70°

NORMAL LOW

60° to 48°

NORMAL RAIN

3.34 in

RECORD HIGH

101° in 2019

RECORD LOW

27° in 1952

Normal highs at the Birmingham airport fall from 82 to 70 degrees over October, and normal rain for the month is 3.34 inches.

It froze at least once in October in 22 of the 96 years on the airport record, and the earliest freeze on record in the month came on October 18, 1948.

THE SUN

October

DAYLIGHT ON THE 1ST

11 h 50 m

ON THE 31ST

10 h 50 m

The days lose 1 hour of daylight over October, from 11 hours and 50 minutes on the 1st to 10 hours and 50 minutes on the 31st.

DATES IN OCTOBER

OCT 01

CIVIC

GRAYSVILLE

Graysville City Council meeting

Graysville's council meets twice a month, on the first and third Thursday, at 6:00 PM at Graysville City Hall.

OCT
05

CIVIC

BROOKSIDE

Brookside Town Council meeting
Brookside's council meets on the first Monday of the month at 6:00 PM at Brookside Town Hall. When that Monday falls on a holiday the meeting moves to the second Monday.

OCT
07

CIVIC

Jefferson County tornado siren test
Jefferson County tests its outdoor warning sirens on the first Wednesday of each month at 10:00 AM. No action needed, it is a scheduled test.

OCT
13

CIVIC

CARDIFF

Cardiff City Council meeting
Cardiff City Council meets on the second Tuesday of each month at 6:00 PM.

OCT
15

CIVIC

GRAYSVILLE

Graysville City Council meeting
Graysville's council meets twice a month, on the first and third Thursday, at 6:00 PM at Graysville City Hall.

OCT
17

CIVIC

Household Hazardous Waste Collection
Jefferson County HHW drop-off. The nearest site to these towns is Camp Ketona (121 County Shop Road). Accepts chemicals, paint, batteries, and other household hazardous materials. 8:00 AM to 11:30 AM.
[Jefferson County \(https://www.jccal.org/Default.asp?ID=2294&pg=Electronics+Hazardous+Materials\)](https://www.jccal.org/Default.asp?ID=2294&pg=Electronics+Hazardous+Materials)

OCT
25

SKY

Hunter's Moon
The first full moon after the Harvest Moon.
[Wikipedia ↗ \(https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hunter%27s_moon\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hunter%27s_moon)

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The month's weather is the **FIVEMILE** weather station. Normals, ranks, records and the thirds a month is scored in are the official National Weather Service record kept at the Birmingham airport since 1930, set against 1991 to 2020. The creek is the [USGS gauge on Fivemile Creek near Republic \(https://waterdata.usgs.gov/monitoring-location/02457595/\)](https://waterdata.usgs.gov/monitoring-location/02457595/). The outlook is the monthly outlook from [NOAA's Climate Prediction Center \(https://www.cpc.ncep.noaa.gov/products/predictions/30day/\)](https://www.cpc.ncep.noaa.gov/products/predictions/30day/), read at the middle of the three towns. The

stories are the ones the news page ran, the sightings are iNaturalist's research grade records, and the dates are the calendar's. FIVEMILE's call is a rule written down in advance: it looks at how the month just gone finished and at what followed every earlier year that started the same way. Every sentence here was written ahead of time and filled in from those records, and no edition is changed after it runs.